

Artist CV — Michael F Bergmann

Performance, projection, and machine collaboration

Associate Professor, Performance, The Creative School, Toronto Metropolitan University

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Selected Works

- 2026** “Before I Was This.” Generative text work. flashDRIVE: Digital Arts Fundraiser Exhibition, InterAccess, Toronto, April 22 – May 9, 2026. Curated by Miriam Arbus.
- 2026** Nuptials (feature film). Producer, projection design, and live in-camera VFX. Directed by Sean Braune, Para-sight Productions. Official release February 13, 2026 (Freestyle Digital Media). Best World Feature Film, Austin Revolution Film Festival, 2022.
- 2025** The Frankenstein Project. Producer, with Debashis Sinha. Performance Studio Theatre, TMU, November 18–22, 2025.
- 2025** “To my creators...” Solo work exhibited at the Creative AI Symposium, TMU, April 2, 2025; created during the SÍM residency, Reykjavík.
- 2024** Shipwreck. Group exhibition with UKAI Projects and five Canadian artists, SÍM Gallery, Reykjavík, Iceland, following a month-long residency; includes solo work “To my creators...”
- 2024** Labour and Us. Workshop series (March 14 – April 17, 2024) and performance, co-created and performed with Lucas Carravetta, Matt Endahl, and Aimée Dawn Robinson; roundtable with Alan Filewod, Tom Scholte, Cynthia Ashperger, and Judith Thompson. ImprovLab, University of Guelph, April 19, 2024.
- 2024** Almost Alchemy. Two 360° video experiences of improvised research-creation performance. RUBIX, TMU, January 25, 2024.
- 2019** “The Uncanny Robots Project: Phase 1.” Research-creation premiere examining human-robot interaction through dance, commissioned for the opening of the Creative Technology Lab @ FCAD, TMU, October 2019.
- 2017** Slaughterhouse/Requiem. Projection design; choreography by Belinda McGuire. Harbourfront NextSteps, Fleck Dance Theatre, Toronto.
- 2016** YET. Projection design; choreography by Heidi Strauss. Ryerson Dances, Ryerson Theatre, Toronto.
- 2014** He Left Quietly. Projection design; directed by Leora Morris. SummerWorks Performance Festival, Toronto. Best Production, 2014.
- 2014** echo::system Action Station #2: The Desert. Video design and system design team; choreography by Grisha Coleman. ACCAD, The Ohio State University.
- 2014** TECHknowSELF. Wrote, directed, and designed this multimedia performance (MFA thesis). Becton Engineering Center, Yale University.

2013 – 2014	Accidental Death of an Anarchist. Projection design; directed by Christopher Bayes. Yale Repertory Theatre / Berkeley Repertory Theatre.
2013	Water Closeted (projection installation). Gallery + Drama, Yale University Art Gallery.
2012	On Guard (projection installation). Group showing, Gallery + Drama, Yale University Art Gallery.

Residencies

2025 – 2026	Mentor, Setsubun Digital Media Residency, Japanese Canadian Cultural Centre, Toronto
2024	Artist-in-residence, SÍM Residency (with UKAI Projects), Reykjavík, Iceland — Shipwreck, June 2–30, 2024
2022	Artist-in-residence, Ingenuity Labs Research Institute, Queen's University, Kingston
2021 – 2022	Ferment AI Residency artist; residency output presented in Berlin, October 2022
2014	Artist-in-residence, Ross Creek Centre for the Arts, NS — Incorporeus
2014	Workshop residency, ACCAD, The Ohio State University — echo::system Action Station #2: The Desert

Awards

2022	Best World Feature Film: Nuptials, Austin Revolution Film Festival (as producer)
2014	Best Production: He Left Quietly, SummerWorks Performance Festival (as designer)
2012 – 2014	Eldon Elder Fellowship, Yale University (\$40,000 USD; held throughout the MFA)
2009	Spirit of the Fringe, Prague Fringe Festival
2006	Short-listed, Prix Molière, Theatre Glendon

Collectives and Affiliations

2023 – present	Almost Alchemy — improvised, multi-disciplinary performance collective (founding member)
2022 – 2023	Synectic Assembly — AI-driven art collective (founding member)
2019 – present	United States Institute for Theatre Technology (USITT)
2018 – present	Associated Designers of Canada / IATSE Local ADC 659
2018 – present	Canadian Institute for Theatre Technology (CITT)

Selected Press

- 2023** “Get the inside scoop on game-changing innovations in augmented reality with the new VisionPro.” The Creative School Top 5, July 4, 2023.
- 2023** Faculty Spotlight: Michael F Bergmann. Performance at The Creative School, June 27, 2023.
- 2022** “Students Are Excited And Hopeful For What The Metaverse May Bring.” The Eyeopener, October 5, 2022.
- 2022** “Michael F. Bergmann On The Merging of Live Arts and Technology.” Toronto Life, April 29, 2022.
- 2021** “Emerging technology that’s here to stay.” CityNews Toronto, June 18, 2021.
- 2020** “Can you feel empathy for a dancing robot?” Ryerson Innovation Magazine, Issue 33, 2020.

Education

- 2022 – present** PhD (in progress), Critical Studies in Improvisation, University of Guelph. Expected 2027.
- 2011 – 2014** MFA, Design (Projection Design Specialization), Yale School of Drama, Yale University
- 2006 – 2011** BFA, Theatre Performance Production, Ryerson Theatre School, Toronto Metropolitan University (coursework completed December 2010; graduated May 2011)